

Rep. Tom Emmer on The John Fredericks Show

Radio

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****HOST:**

** Let's welcome the one and only House Majority Whip and Congressman for Minnesota's 6th District, Congressman Tom Emmer.

****HOST:**

** Congressman, Majority Whip Emmer, great to have you with us, sir.

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Good to see you, John.

****HOST:**

** So Tom, let's get right to it. Always good to see you. Always good to see you. I've got to give a shout out, though, before we run out of time, to Sally Fox. You are blessed with her. And I work with communications directors from a variety of aspects, from the White House to the administration to Congress and Senate. She is one of the best I've ever worked with. What a gem she is, and a great hire, and a great lady. So thank you for having her.

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Well, I totally agree, obviously. But don't tell her that, because then we've got to give her a raise.

****HOST:**

** Well-earned and deserved. So Congressman, yesterday, Mike Johnson, your speaker, comes up with a new plan, great plan. And he says, I've got a way to put the SAVE Act into Reconciliation 3.0. And immediately, one of your colleagues from Florida said, no, we can't do that in the conference because the parliamentarian says no. But Johnson was pretty confident that he's got a new pathway for this. Can you explain how this would work, Majority Whip Tom Emmer?

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Well, I think Mike does have a good plan. He's talking about putting this on another reconciliation bill, John. Reconciliation bills only require 50 plus 1 in the Senate. The issue is they have to be done with all Republican votes. So we've got an issue over in the Senate, there's no question. We've got a Senate that uses something called the filibuster and someone called the parliamentarian to avoid taking votes they don't want to take. This is why I say there are no Republicans, there are no Democrats, there are only Senators, John. And the Senators all literally use these two things so they don't have to put a vote on the board. In this case, what Mike's saying is we will do, for instance, our Department of War needs additional funds because of Venezuela, Iran, and what they have to do going forward. All right, let's put that all in a reconciliation bill because we know that Democrats

aren't going to help President Trump. Democrats don't care if they put the American public at risk. They've shown this, they could care less about our military men and women around the world. So we'll have to do it. We put it on a reconciliation bill here in the House. We add the Save America Act to it, John. We send it to the Senate. They will give it to their parliamentarian, which they always do, and I would fully expect the parliamentarian to drop it out of the bill and say, well, this isn't appropriate for this bill. At that point, guess what? It only takes 50 plus one Senators to overrule the parliamentarian. So this nonsense about we can't get 60 votes, all you need is 50 plus one. That's what Mike's saying. Let's do it again. Let's send it over to the Senate with this, for instance, defense supplemental, and force them to put their vote on the board. If you really want to tell America you're not for fair and open and transparent elections, all right, well, I guess there's nothing we can do there.

****HOST:**

** You know, Majority Whip Ben Whittaker, our member with us from Minnesota's 6th District, that's brilliant. The way he, the way you just outlined that in layman's terms that everybody can understand. So they don't want to break the filibuster. They don't want to do that. They don't want to fire the parliamentarian. So all you have to do is get 50 Senators to vote that in the reconciliation, regardless of what the parliamentarian says, because Vance could break the tie, and then the vote goes on the floor. So basically, you just, you need 50 Republican Senators to just put it in the bill and then go from there. But they're not going to, because he'll, so, but then, then John Thune basically finds four people that don't vote for it, and they skirt it again. How do you overcome that?

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Well, I mean, that's up to John and I, I'm, you know, unlike others who I think are very critical of John at this point, John makes his own decisions. I'm a big John Thune fan, John Frederick, I really am. But in this case, what he's doing is he's allowing three or four U.S. Senators, Republicans, to what, impress their will on the American people. John, if you can't pass an 80% issue in the Senate, what the hell are you doing there? I mean, just to ask yourself, you got, how awful is it that we're asking someone to one prove they are a citizen of the United States and therefore eligible to vote? And number two, when they show up at the voting precinct, that they present identification to prove they are that citizen who is eligible to vote. John, 80% of this country, Republican, Democrat, and other agree with that. If you can't pass that through the U.S. Senate, I don't know what you're doing there. So again, I'm a John Thune fan. It's his decision. You put it on the floor. This is what Mike Johnson is saying. You overrule the parliamentarian. There's plenty of precedent for that. This has been done before. After all, it is the U.S. Senate and the U.S. House of Representatives that are supposed to be making laws, John, not parliamentarians. So there you go.

****HOST:**

** So when you talk to John Thune and you're saying that you're a supporter of his, Tom, and you're a friend of his, when you talk to him about this directly, without sharing anything that's confidential, the frustration that many of us have is that he won't go to the talking filibuster. He won't put this on the floor to a vote. What does he say when you ask him to do that?

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Well, first, I don't share what we talk about, but much like you and I can talk about it, but I won't tell you what the president tells me when he's talking about what he wants to do. I'll let him do that. I'll let John do that. But I can't help myself but look at this and say, you're doing, John, you are doing what you believe is the right thing because that's the way it's always been done in the Senate. But what you got to understand, times have changed. Much like the House, when I've got the old bulls of the House telling me nobody ever votes against

rules, John, that's voting against the team. It's like, well, you don't understand. They do vote against rules now. That's part of the equation. We have to have that discussion beforehand. The world has changed, and the idea that U.S. senators are going to avoid the responsibility to vote yes or no to show the American people they're either with them or they're not, those days are gone. I mean, you can push back against the president who's very frustrated, okay, that's your right, but you represent the American public, John. They want this done. They are sick and tired of senators and U.S. representatives making excuses to them for not doing their job. This is just an excuse for not doing the job, and again, John, I think John thinks he's doing the right thing based on the history of the Senate, but history's changing, John. That's why they call it history, because some of it is from the past. It doesn't happen anymore. This should be history.

****HOST:**

** And Tom Emmer, you understand the frustration of the MAGA base with John Thune, right?

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** I'm right there with him, although here's the difference between me and the MAGA base. I know John personally. I know John wants to do the right thing. I know John is an American patriot, but he's in the U.S. Senate, and that does something to people. Apparently, they go over there, they sniff that rarefied air. They're kind of in a bubble separated from the rough and tumble of the street. They got to get back out onto the street. All those guys got to understand they are not gods unto themselves. They are still representatives, elected representatives, who have responsibilities to the people who elected them, and I think that'll come around.

****HOST:**

** Majority Whip Tom Emmer with us, Minnesota Sixth. Before we get to some of the key issues, I just got to ask you this question. You're the Majority Whip. I think you deserve the trophy of all time. How do you get this stuff through the House with a two-seat majority? This is unheard of, especially with a conference that it's not like the Democrats where Hakeem Jeffries says jump, everybody says how high. You've got diversification of thought all over the place. How are you able as a Whip to get this stuff passed with a two-vote majority?

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** First off, John, Hakeem Jeffries is a loser. He says jump, and they say F you. That's what they're saying to him today. He doesn't have any sway over on the other side. But your question to me is a valid one, and I will respond based on what we just talked about with the Senate. How do we get things done in the House? If I had a Bitcoin for every time I heard, I just need a little bit more time. You know, how much time do you need? Well, maybe 10 days. No, today is the day. You are going to say yes, you're going to say no. You're going to do it in front of the American public, God, and your mother, all right? And you are going to show us who you are and who you represent. That's how you get things done, John. You put it up on the board. Our members know who they represent. They understand that the job is to be a servant leader, not to be a ruler. And so once we put the vote on the board, amazing things happen. Not always. I mean, every once in a while, you've got some people, and this is the way the system should work. You got people who are here fighting for the things that they came here to fight for, for the people that voted for them. That's what they believe they're doing. We got to help them do that. We got to help them feel like they are achieving what they got elected to achieve. If we do that, John, it's amazing. Our people are so different from one coast to another. There are so many different political perspectives in the House. It's what makes it fun. I mean, I don't know that I deserve an award. I owe somebody something. This is the greatest job in America. You get to see all of America, from the East Coast to the West Coast and everywhere in between in the members that we have in the House. It's fun. It's exciting. Every day. What's that movie that says every day is like a box of chocolates, right? It's all something different, although

they aren't as sweet. You never know what you're going to pull out of the box for the movie.

****HOST:**

** But Tom Emmer, you do deserve a look. I've been covering I've been covering this stuff since since Gingrich took over in 92. I was at Capital Steps when he outlined the contract for America that I thought was the most brilliant thing ever ever been done in politics. But I've never seen a whip like Tom Emmer that has been able to get this done because nobody's ever had just a two seat majority. I mean, it's unbelievable what you've been able able to do. Let's get to the Marx. Let's get to the communist victories last night in New York. You add that. I live in Washington, D.C. I won my election, by the way, or two chairman. Thank you. But in D.C., we've got communist mayor is is going to be ushered in. Janice Lewis George, two of the new council members here, communist in L.A. You're going to get a communist mayor. She's going to destroy Karen Bass. You got three communists elected in New York City, along with Mondami. What is going on with these people? What is this about?

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Well, this is what our founders were running from, right? Tyrants. And that's what we're now elected. And thank you, John. Thank you for calling them what they are. I'm tired of my colleagues who say, you know, the socialists, the socialists are gone. You're now talking about Marxists. You're talking about communists. These people are are horrible here. What's happening? Well, everybody thinks they get a free lunch. These guys are promising things that they will never be able to deliver. People who have lived in in countries that have this type of leadership. I mean, we've got a large Cuban population, Venezuelan population, population down in Florida and elsewhere. These people know that it doesn't work and they know it doesn't end well, John. I mean, people should go back to reading The Road to Serfdom. The great economist Hayek, who wrote this book for his political elites back during World War Two when it was to give them an idea about this awful thing called capitalism and how the socialist approach, this central authority doesn't work. If you boil down that book and again, people should go back and read it because it's just as relevant today as it was when Hayek wrote that book. He talks about how, oh, it's all wonderful. We have a central authority that will allocate resources based on their decisions rather than the free hand of the market that we know from Adam Smith. He says it sounds great and it is great as long as you are part of that central authority making the decisions. If you're not part of the central authority, you may not like the decisions that they're making. You may not like your allocation and you'll complain. And by the way, in the beginning you complain, they might take away some of your liberties. If you continue to complain, they might take away a lot more. They might take away your life before it's over. So that's what these people are selling. That's what these young people who we have not educated well in this country are buying. And by the way, it too will burn out. The cowboy spirit is alive and well in the United States of America. You're talking about aberrations in the city of New York. You're talking about aberrations in the city of L.A. By the way, you tell me how it works. I'm not a smart guy. I'm just a Midwestern kid who looks at this thing in L.A. and says, all right, so you got the early votes and you've got Karen Bass. You've got Pratt, I think it was. And then you've got this communist number three. OK, then you have the same day voting. You've got the same thing, Karen Bass. You've got the guy named Pratt, number two, and then you've got this communist number three. Then you have the ballots that come in later. And John, every one of them is for the third place candidate. How does that work, John? How does that work when it goes one, two, three, one, two, three, and now all of a sudden it's just three? I mean, the whole thing is it stinks to high heaven. It's crooked. I think the American people is waking up. Unfortunately, we sometimes have to do everything else before we figure out how to do the right thing. And I think it's coming.

****HOST:**

**** Majority Whip Emmer, what did you think of the United States postmaster making the ruling or the decision yesterday that he won't deliver or have the UPS deliver mail-out ballots to states that have not complied with the DOJ, with President Trump's executive order to turn their voting rolls over to be scrutinized to get rid of illegals and other people that shouldn't be on them?**

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

**** I think it's great. I mean, I think we should tie HAVA funds. You know, the Help America Vote Act, the federal government sends HAVA funds to the states to administer their elections. I think we should do the same thing there. They should not get one dollar of federal help to run their elections if they're not willing to guarantee that those elections are fair, open, and transparent. The president and I had this conversation about Minnesota. Minnesota is one of the most crooked operations in the world. Why would anybody want to run for a statewide office in Minnesota until they fix the election thing? Think about this, John. The U.S. government, the Department of Justice, asked the Secretary of State, Steve Simon, to provide the voter rolls two years ago, right after the Trump administration took office. Why? Because the state is responsible to administer not just the state elections for state office, but the federal elections. So the federal government is entitled to see that, in fact, you are doing that in a fair, open, and honest way. Guess what? The state of Minnesota not only has refused, but made them sue them in court. I will tell you, I think they're trying to run out the clock before the election because they have no interest in proving. In fact, there's a Minnesota state legislator when asked, well, why don't you want to clean the dead people deceased off your voter rolls? And this gal said, well, it's actually a voter integrity issue. Because if somebody uses one of those false names, we know that they're cheating in the election. John, they have no idea if somebody is cheating in the election because they don't care. So I think what he did yesterday, I think it's just the beginning. And I do think our senators should buck up and pass the Save America Act. 80% of Americans agree with this, Republican, Democrat, and other. Stop telling us what you think the world should be and start listening to the people that you represent. That's what they got to do in the Senate.**

****HOST:**

**** 100% Tom Emmer. I'm going to run a clip here that shows that 21% now of Americans believe that, well, the fraud's OK. This is a stunner. Take a look. I want to put this poll up, Nick, because I was kind of surprised at these numbers. This is Fox News polling on fraud. Look at this. It's federal efforts to combat fraud in government programs. You see right there on the screen, too much, 21%, not enough, 60%, about right, 17%. I'm surprised at the 21%. There are 21% of Americans who think that we should not combat fraud. We're spending too much money combating this, and look at all the money we are saving. What do you think about those numbers, Nick?**

****NICK:**

**** Well, there might be 21% of America who needs the fraud to continue, unfortunately.**

****HOST:**

**** What is your reaction to this?**

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

**** I think it shows us that the 20%, those are the fraudsters, John. Those are the people we're chasing. I think we're not doing enough. I think we need to do even more to go after the fraudsters. My state, unfortunately, is the poster child, and that clip that you have of Nick Shirley, he's the guy who came into Minnesota. We've been writing letters. We've been trying to sound the alarm on this for seven, eight years. It took Nick Shirley, first it**

took the greatest president in my life, Donald J. Trump, perhaps one of the greatest presidents in the history of this country, to raise this to a national level. Before he brought it up, and the Minnesota media thought they were going to take on Donald Trump because he called Somalis exactly what they are, the Somali fraudsters, right? Well, they got into it with him, and all of a sudden they realized they had just elevated this story to a national issue. Then Nick Shirley comes into Minnesota. He does something that our worthless media refuse to do. He goes to these different sites, and he videotapes. It's supposed to be spelled Learning Center, but it's spelled Leering Center. They can't even get the sign right. There's nobody there. I mean, we've got daycare fraud. We've got autism center fraud. We've got Medicaid housing fraud. We've got fraud in every damn program you can think of. We've got fraud in the SNAP program, more commonly known as Food Stamp. Every program in the state of Minnesota, and by the way, California, where Nick Shirley comes from, has got 40 million people. You expect they're going to have fraud. We've got 5.7 million people in Minnesota, and we've got billions of dollars that have been built out of the taxpayers of Minnesota. Sadly, Minnesota punches above its weight when it comes to fraud. We've got to do even more, John.

****HOST:**

** What's the deal with Ilhan Omar? Ilhan Omar, she doesn't appreciate the country that saved her life. Ilhan Omar should be denaturalized and shipped back to Somalia. If she doesn't love this country, which she clearly does not, she doesn't belong here, John. So what's with Ilhan Omar?

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Ilhan Omar is part of the problem. I hope that Ilhan Omar, Keith Ellison, and Tim Walz, I hope that they can ultimately get enough evidence so they can prosecute all three of them. My constituents keep saying, it's not just, are you going after the fraud? They're saying, when is somebody going to be held accountable for this stuff? I mean, Tim Walz knew this was going on as early as 2019, and he chose not only to do nothing about it, he and his administration literally intimidated whistleblowers to continue making payments to the Somali fraudsters. So these guys should go to jail.

****HOST:**

** You know, yesterday I had on one of your representatives, State House members, Representative Kristen Roberts. Roberts. Roberts. Kristen Roberts. Roberts. I'm sorry. District 37, West Minneapolis, who's the head of this fraud. She's the head of the fraud division there in the House, and there's no power share. And she was telling our audience, Tom, yesterday that she believes that the fraud in Minnesota is in the excess of \$10 billion, in the excess of that. And she says every time they turn over a stone, they see more of it. And she said there are, they said there are people that are doing this. It's a planned economy. Like they figure out how to do it, and then they bring in all their friends. And she says there's no oversight. You can basically apply for this stuff, she said, on a cocktail napkin and get money. I mean, it's incredible to think that \$10 billion is being stole out of your state government This is, she said, on an annual basis. How do you guys survive that?

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** I don't know how we survive it. I mean, look, they not only have done all that, John, these people are so arrogant and they are so out of touch. They changed our Minnesota state flag. People listening to your program should go look up the new Minnesota state flag and then compare it to the flag of the country of Somalia. They are almost identical, John. This is who these people are. They're not, they don't love America. They don't love the people they represent. And Kristen is a great example. She runs the fraud subcommittee in the House. She's done amazing work. And if she says it's over \$10 billion, I'm going to believe Kristen. I am very sad when I see articles written by our worthless media. There was one, they've already proven almost a billion dollars of

fraud. And what was the article? Well, it's not quite a billion. So the hundreds of millions that you acknowledge have been stolen, you know, that's not the issue. The issue is that you don't have the math perfect. I mean, it's outrageous when you look at what goes on in Minnesota. And eventually the sad part about this, John, is while I don't agree that government should be administering all these programs in the first place, they are intended for the disabled. They are intended for the elderly. They are intended for single mothers that need the assistance so that they can be productive members of our society. These people are stealing from those that need it the most, John. And I don't know how you look the other way. And that's literally what Kristen is complaining about when she's talking to you, is that she keeps saying, I'm covering these things. She keeps turning over another stone and finding another fraudulent program. And nobody seems to want to do anything about it. So God bless Donald Trump for wanting to do something about it. J.D. Vance.

****HOST:**

** Majority Whip Tom Emmer, I'm going to let you go. But before I do that, I've got to bring in your great friend, Dan Ochsner, the Ochs in Minnesota. He heard you're on. He like dial. He's got to come in to say hi to his good friend, Tom Emmer.

****HOST:**

** Hey, Ochsner, I'm with the Majority Whip.

****DAN OCHSNER:**

** Mr. Godzilla, Mr. Congressman, how are you, buddy?

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** I'm doing well, Dan. I miss you. I miss you, Dan Ochsner.

****DAN OCHSNER:**

** Appreciate that. I'm coming soon, though. I'll be there.

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** All right. Can't wait to see you.

****HOST:**

** He is a voice of truth in Minnesota, John. We don't have a lot of them. Well, he just invited me to come up and in August, I asked and she wants to go. I'm going to put in my calendar Majority Whip Tom Emmer doing the yeoman's yeoman's work. I don't know how this guy, Dan, gets these votes through Congress to see majority. It's just unbelievable. I've never seen anything like this. I've been covering the House since Newt Gingrich in 92. I've never seen him get the whip, get all these votes through with a two seat majority and and he's always got problems in. I don't know how he does it. But Tom, super job. Thank you. We're going to follow Majority Whip Tom Emmer at GOP Majority Whip at GOP Majority Whip. Final question. Vikings. How many games will they win?

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** We're going to win the Super Bowl this year. This is our year. I'm telling you right now. I think JJ is the man. Nice to have that gamer kid they picked up from my from my Arizona, but JJ is going to lead us to the promised land.

****HOST:**

** You know, every year is our year. This one, I'm convinced we'll see. We'll talk after the first game. The gamer kid. OK, that's a classic. He's a gamer. I mean, the guy's up at two in the morning, apparently playing a Call of Duty when he's got a game the next day at noon. And we've got him in Minnesota. Hey, Tyler, thanks for playing. We'll send you on your way. I'm sure. Very soon.

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** I don't have an opinion aside from that, John, I think you got my twins spent no money and they've almost won 40 games already this year. It's amazing.

****HOST:**

** Hey, I love watching them. You know, I'm a I'm a hater. And thank you for giving us Carlos Correa back. He's out for the season. But the twins did the rebuild the right way. And I've said that on my support show since the beginning. They kept Buxton. They kept Joe Ryan. They kept a couple of veterans. They did it the right way. And now they've got a bunch of triple A players, young players enjoying the game, having fun. And that's why they're winning. And it is the right way to do a rebuild. You guys are going to win that division.

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** You know, John, from your lips to God's ears, I would love that. That would you know, us Minnesotans, we just like to have a good season.

****DAN OCHSNER:**

** Right. Right, Dan. Oh, gosh, golly. Gee whiz. The kids did really well this year. They didn't win anything, but they look really good.

****HOST:**

** You're going to win the division. Tigers have tanked White Sox. But Joe Ryan is going to going to be the guy. And I tell you what, playing them in a three game, even if they get to the wild card, nobody wants to face Joe Ryan in a best of three in that first game. He's been dominant this season. That four seamer that rises and one of the best of the game, by the way, where's your son playing this summer, John?

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Well, you know, he's still rehabbing. They're determined to get him back at 100 percent strength. So they had him stay in campus. No summer ball. He's got two more years of eligibility with the University of Maryland. He'll probably be their closer. And we look forward to him having a great junior season.

****HOST:**

** So after you get John up to Minnesota, you and I got to go join him in a Maryland baseball game. We got to see this kid is.

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Can't wait. You got to come. Eight stops on the metro. The Green Line. We're good to go. That's it. Eight states, eight stops.

****HOST:**

** Tom, thank you. Thank you for being with us at GOP Majority Whip at GOP Majority Whip. I notice the transcript segment appears to be empty or missing from your message. Could you please share the actual transcript text you'd like me to add speaker labels to? Once you provide the transcript segment, I'll format it with the appropriate speaker labels:

- ****DAN OCHSNER:**

**

- ****HOST:**

**

- ****NICK:**

**

- ****REP. TOM EMMER:**

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